TCS India FAQs – Bouquet of Benefits

VERSION 6.0

TATA CONSULTANCY SERVICES

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1. Where is my Bouquet of Benefits (BoB) reflected in my compensation letter?

Bouquet of Benefits (BoB) no longer appears as a separate component in the revised compensation letter. Under the revised compensation structure, House Rent Allowance (HRA) and/or Conveyance Allowance are reflected as components of compensation. However, the BoB module will continue to be available to enable employees to reallocate these allowances into one or more eligible benefit components, subject to applicable policy provisions.

2. If Bouquet of Benefits (BoB) no longer appears in my compensation letter, how can House Rent Allowance (HRA) and/or Conveyance Allowance be optimized from a tax benefit perspective?

Under the revised BoB framework in GESS, the House Rent Allowance (HRA) and/or Conveyance Allowance reflected in the compensation letter may be restructured into the following components for tax optimization purposes, in accordance with applicable policy guidelines:

- House Rent Allowance (HRA)
- Conveyance Allowance (newly introduced)
- Meal Card (optional benefit)
- Communication Card (optional benefit)
- National Pension Scheme (NPS) (optional benefit)
- Superannuation (Available for C3B and above equivalent grades) (optional benefit)

BoB components that cease to exist:

- Leave Travel Allowance (LTA)
- Vehicle Maintenance
- Car Allowance
- Fuel Allowance
- Personal Allowance

For more details, you can refer to TCS-India FAQ Compensation Restructuring at HR Policy Hub.

3. Are the tax benefits same as earlier BoB linked Pay elements?

Pay elements with no tax benefits have been discontinued. However, for some of the components tax benefits are either enhanced or remain unchanged as listed below:

- **Meal Card** – Tax exemption enhanced upto INR 12,000 per month effective 1 June 2026 as per company policy, under both new and old tax regimes subject to valid meal card details being made available in GESS *(GESS → My Profile → Benefit Card).*
- **Communication Card** - Tax exemption upto INR 2000 per month under both new and old tax regimes subject to valid communication card details being made available in GESS *(GESS → My Profile → Benefit Card).*
- **NPS**- Tax exemption upto 14% of basic salary in New Tax Regime and upto 10% of basic salary for Old Tax Regime subject to valid NPS account details in GESS with approved corporate PRAN
- **Superannuation** - Tax exemption upto defined limit. Currently contributed at 15% of Basic Salary if opted for. This is applicable for C3B and equivalent grades, only if the associate has opted for Superannuation.

- **Conveyance Non-Taxable**- This is applicable only for persons with disability as per applicable limits.
  Refer to **Question No. 2** to understand which of the erstwhile BOB elements have been discontinued.

4. What components are eligible under BoB and what are their limits?

Under BoB, HRA is mandatory and must be minimum 5% of Basic Salary.

All other components are optional and can be entered as zero. Negative and decimal values are not allowed.

The eligible components and limits are:

1. **HRA:** Minimum 5% of Basic Salary; maximum up to the TCS Default BoB total*.
2. **Conveyance Allowance:** The entire remaining balance of the TCS Default BoB total.
3. **Meal Card:** Maximum ₹12,000 per month.
4. **Communication Card:** Maximum ₹2,000 per month.
5. **NPS:** Minimum ₹6,000 per year; maximum 14% of Annual Basic Salary.
6. **Superannuation:** Non-editable; 15% of Basic Salary is auto-added if opted. Applicable only for C3B grade equivalents and above.
7. **Conveyance Tax Exempt (Employees with Disabilities):** Non-taxable under both tax regimes – INR 15,000 per month for metro cities and INR 8,000 per month for non-metro cities.

**TCS Default BoB total - the amount is allocated under House Rent Allowance (HRA) and/or Conveyance Allowance as per your compensation letter.*

5. What is the taxability of BoB components under Old and New Tax Regimes?

Component	New Tax Regime	Old Tax Regime
HRA	Taxable	Non-taxable based on prescribed conditions
Conveyance Allowance	Taxable	Taxable
Meal Card	Fully Non-taxable	Fully Non-taxable
Communication Card	Fully Non-taxable	Fully Non-taxable
Conveyance Tax Exempt (Employees with Disabilities)	Metro – INR 15,000 per month - non-taxable Non-Metro – INR 8,000 per month - non-taxable.	Metro – INR 15,000 per month non-taxable Non-Metro – INR 8,000 per month- non-taxable.
NPS (Corporate PRAN)	Up to 14% of yearly Basic Salary – Non-taxable	Up to 10% of yearly Basic Salary – Non-taxable
Superannuation	Non-taxable (Superannuation is non-taxable as long as the total yearly retiral contributions (PF + Superannuation + NPS) do not exceed ₹7,50,000.	Non-taxable (Superannuation is non-taxable as long as the total yearly retiral contributions (PF + Superannuation + NPS) do not exceed ₹7,50,000.)

6. What is the TCS Defined Default Amount Structure in BoB portal?

- The TCS Defined Default Amount in BoB portal in GESS is based on the employee's grade and annual compensation.
- The total "House Rent Allowance and/or Conveyance Allowance" Amount is automatically split equally between HRA and Conveyance.
- If the employee has opted for Superannuation, the Superannuation amount is displayed separately. With every compensation revision, the HRA and/or Conveyance allowance and Superannuation amount are updated automatically in the same manner.

7. What is TCS Defined Current Amount Structure in BoB portal?

TCS Defined Current Amount Structure shows how your BoB is adjusted after compensation revision.

- For the first time, post salary restructuring, TCS Defined Current Amount Structure depicts your TCS defined current BoB which will have NPS amount and Superannuation amount (if any) carried forward from earlier BoB. The remaining amount of House Rent Allowance and/or Conveyance Allowance will be split automatically.
- After the first time of redesigning your BoB, the same components are carried forward.
- Any revised (addition or reduction) "House Rent Allowance and/or Conveyance Allowance" amount will automatically split as 50% to HRA and 50% to Conveyance with HRA at minimum of 5% of Basic Salary.
- If you had not defined BoB component earlier, the total "House Rent Allowance and/or Conveyance Allowance" amount is automatically split as 50% HRA and 50% Conveyance with HRA at minimum 5% of Basic Salary.
- With every compensation revision, the HRA and/or Conveyance and Superannuation amount are updated automatically in the same manner.

8. What is Employee Defined Amount Structure in BoB portal?

Employee Defined Structure is the structure where you can distribute the available BoB across eligible components with maximum capping limits.

You can allocate amounts only to eligible BoB components, subject to their maximum allowed limits.

The total amount allocated across all components must match the TCS Defined (Default) or TCS Defined Current Amount.

9. I am unable to view the Conveyance allowance and only see House Rent Allowance component.

As per statutory requirements, HRA needs to be maintained at a minimum of 5% of basic salary. In scenario where your 'HRA and/or Conveyance Allowance' as per compensation letter is not more than 5% of your Basic salary, Conveyance allowance will not be available.

10. For how long is the chosen BoB valid?

The BoB defined by the employee remains valid until the employee modifies it or until the next compensation revision, whichever occurs earlier.

11. Till what date can I update the BoB to get the benefit in the same month?

The associate has to update the BoB by the 10th of each month to receive the benefit in the same month.

12. If my BoB has already been declared in the system for the previous year, do I still need to re-declare it in the current financial year to avail tax benefits?

Yes, redeclaration is recommended, particularly in case of a compensation revision.

For the current financial year (FY27), the BoB declared in the previous year will not be carried forward. Employees are required to re-declare their BoB to continue availing of tax benefits.

In general, whenever there is a revision in compensation, employees should review and re-define their BoB to best suit their requirements and maximize tax efficiency.

If there is a revision in compensation and the associate does not define the BoB, the revised portion of the House Rent Allowance and/or Conveyance Allowance will be automatically split in a 50:50 ratio between HRA and Conveyance.

13. Can I define my BoB while on long term deputation?

Yes. All employees who come under the India Payroll have the facility to change the BoB from any location. Meal and Communication Card should not be applied while on deputation and existing allocation should be changed to other elements during deputation. Employees deputed in following countries are only allowed to update PRAN details. They cannot opt for NPS contribution through BoB during their deputation.

APAC	Australia, Hong Kong, Singapore, Japan, Malaysia, New Zealand
Europe	Poland, Austria, Hungary, Portugal, Belgium, Romania, Bulgaria, Italy, Slovakia, Spain, Czech Republic, Luxembourg, Switzerland, Denmark, Estonia, Finland, Norway, Germany
LATAM	Colombia, Uruguay, Peru, Ecuador, Mexico
MEA	Israel
North America	USA, Canada
UK&I	UK, Ireland

14. What happens to Meal card and Communication Card when an associate is deputed overseas?

If Meal and Communication card is continued in BoB during deputation, the amount allocated to Meal and Communication Card will be paid in the associate's India Salary under Miscellaneous component.

15. Why is my LTA component discontinued?

LTA is discontinued as a standalone component to simplify the salary structure, while maintaining your overall salary.

16. How does discontinuation of LTA affect my tax benefits?

Currently there is no tax benefit offered for LTA in the New Tax Regime. Since LTA does not exist as an individual component, the specific income-tax exemption linked to LTA travel claims will not apply in the same manner as earlier.

17. How do I get the HRA tax benefit?

To avail HRA tax benefits, the associate must select the Old Tax Regime and raise a Rent Request in Tax Manager under TRLP.

The HRA tax exemption is calculated as the least of the following:

1. Actual HRA received, as declared in BoB
2. Actual house rent paid minus 10% of Basic Salary
3. 50% of Basic Salary for Metro locations or 40% of Basic Salary for Non-Metro locations

18. Where can I declare my PRAN?

To apply for PRAN, please follow the path in **Ultimatix >> Employee Services >> Employee Self Service (ESS) >> Global ESS >> Benefits & Taxes >> Bouquet of Benefits >> Update PRAN.**

19. Who will all be able to define NPS Component of BoB?

Only employees who have registered their PRAN under NPS Corporate model with HDFC Pension & updated/declared their PRAN details will be allowed to define NPS Component in BoB.

20. How do I enroll for PRAN to avail NPS benefits?

To avail corporate NPS benefits, associates must register for PRAN online via the link below and ensure it is tagged under the TCS – Corporate Sector Model with HDFC Pension.

Click here for the Registration

Registration Guidelines

1. Copy and paste the link in an Internet browser.
2. Select "Corporate Subscriber" during registration.

3. Register using your personal email ID.
4. Enter the first three letters of the company name and wait for it to appear.
5. After PRAN generation, share your PRAN number and the e-signed form with HDFC Pension team for confirmation.

6. For support, please contact the HDFC representatives below:
   Mr. Rahul Mandal – rahul.m956@hdfcpension.com | ☎ 97660 89657
   Ms. Anushka Jadhav – anushkaj@hdfcpension.com | ☎ 91687 83264

Update PRAN Details in Ultimatix

1. Once PRAN is generated, update your details using the path below:
2. **Ultimatix → Employee Services → Employee Self Service → Global ESS → Benefits & Taxes → Bouquet of Benefits → Update PRAN**
3. CHO Registration Number: 5513023 (auto-populated) & do not change.
4. Update NPS Contribution in BoB
5. After PRAN approval, update your NPS contribution via:
   Ultimatix → Employee Services → Employee Self Service → Global ESS → Benefits → Bouquet of Benefits → Apply BoB

21. What is the minimum and maximum amount that can be defined under the NPS component?

The minimum amount that can be defined under the NPS is ₹6,000 per year. The maximum amount can be up to 14% of the yearly Basic Salary or 10% of the yearly Basic Salary depending on your tax regime, after maintaining minimum 5% of Basic Salary in HRA.

22. I currently have a Food Card. Is this the same as Meal Card? Will my benefit be automatically credited to the card?

Food Card is the same as Meal Card. To keep availing this benefit, please re-configure the Meal Card amount up to a ceiling of INR 12,000 in GESS BoB. Current BoB will not carry forward previous meal card amount in BoB by default. Employees will need to re-define this amount before the payroll cutoff date to avail of tax benefit.

23. I need more information about the Meal Card—how to avail it, which vendors are available, and where to add it in Ultimatix - GESS?

You will get all the necessary information, including how to avail the Meal Card, available vendors, and where to add/update the details from the TCS India Policy & FAQ on Meal card, which will be accessible through the below link in due course.

Ultimatix – Employee Services – Policies – HR Policy Hub – Benefits – Allowance, Entitlements & Claims – Meal Card.

24. I need more information about the Communication Card—how to avail it, which vendors are available, and where to add it in Ultimatix - GESS?

You will get all the necessary information, including how to avail the Communication Card, available vendors, and where to add/update the details from the TCS India Policy & FAQ on Communication card, which will be accessible through the below link in due course.

Ultimatix – Employee Services – Policies – HR Policy Hub – Benefits – Allowance, Entitlements & Claims – Communication Card.

25. What is the maximum limit defined for Communication Card?

The maximum limit prescribed for communication card is INR 2,000 per month. This needs to be defined in the BoB – GESS. Current BoB will not carry forward previous communication allowance amount in BoB by default. Employees will need to re-define this amount before the payroll cut off to avail tax benefit.

26. If I have used my 3 attempts to redefine BoB but I have got a promotion, will I get an additional chance to redefine BoB?

In case promoted and have already utilized their 3 chances of defining BoB, an additional chance to redefine BoB is given to them.

27. If I get a promotion but still have one chance to redefine BoB, will I get an additional chance to redefine BoB.

In case an employee promoted but still has one chance to re-define BoB, the employee will not get an additional chance to redefine.

28. If I have used my 3 attempts to re-define BoB and also additional chance on promotion, will I get an additional chance for defining NPS Component of BoB?

No. In case employees have already used their three chances of defining BoB and also the chance on promotion, there will not be any additional chance of redefining the NPS Component. You would get a chance to reset your BoB at the start of the next Financial Year.

29. Whom should I reach out to when I want more details on Bouquet of Benefits?

You may connect with your HRBP for additional clarity. You may also raise a ticket in Ultimatix Global Helpdesk.

For any assistance on Bouquet of Benefits, you may log a ticket under: ***TCS Global Helpdesk > Ultimatix Services > Global – ESS > BoB***

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Revision List

Revision Version No.	Policy effective date	Document Release/ Revision Date	Revision Description	Section No.	Rationale for change	Change type (add/modify/delete)	Policy revision/ Document revision
6.0	1 June 2026	10 June 2026	BoB consolidated into HRA & Conveyance Allowance in compensation letter, with redesign flexibility via GESS.	Throughout the document	Change of Compensation Approach	Modify	Policy Revision
6.0	1 June 2026	10 June 2026	Details of current BoB components and structure explained.	Throughout the document	Change of Compensation Approach	Modify	Policy Revision
5.0	1 April 2023	11 April 2023	To include content Communication Allowance Component	Throughout	New component	Add	Policy Revision